PAWAN K SINGH

HRBP | Strategic HR | People & Culture | Employee Engagement & DEIB Leader

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Strategic and dynamic HR leader with 9+ years of experience in building and scaling People & Culture functions. Skilled and adept in end-to-end HR operations, employee lifecycle management, DEIB, policy design and development, employer branding, and compliance. Recognised for spearheading initiatives that enhanced retention, engagement, and performance, including hybrid work models, sabbaticals, and wellness frameworks. Combines empathetic leadership with data-driven insights to deliver measurable impact across diverse sectors.

People & Culture Strategy | Employee Lifecycle & Grievance Handling | Employer Branding & Internal Communications | Talent & Succession Planning | HR Compliance & Policy Formulation | Employee Engagement & Retention | Compensation Benchmarking & Pay Structuring | HRMS & HR Analytics (Zoho, SAP, Darwinbox) | Policy Design (POSH, Hybrid Work, Sabbatical Leave) | DEIB Frameworks & Implementation | CSR & ESG | Wellness & Mental Health Programs | Merger, Transition & Change Management | PMS & 360 Feedback | Early Life Intervention (ELI)

CERTIFICATIONS AND AWARDS

- Google-backed Certification: HR Management, Talent Development, People & Culture, DEIB, Employer Branding
- ThrivePass India – Incredible Workplaces™ Certified
- WeKare Changemakers Award, Capgemini
- XtraMile & Out-of-the-Box Awards, Capgemini
- Capgemini Leadership Award for Multi-tasking & Innovation
- Client Appreciation – Employee Engagement Initiatives
- Featured in #LoveYourCareer Campaign, Capgemini

EXPERIENCE

Thrivepass, People and Culture Lead India

Sept 2024 - Present

Early Life Intervention (ELI) Lead | People & Culture HR

Driving cultural integration, retention, and early employee experience across global operations.

- **Employee Lifecycle & Early Engagement (0–90 Days):** Designed and executed a structured early employee experience strategy covering onboarding, induction, buddy systems, and cultural assimilation; created a seamless transition from recruitment to role readiness.
- **Retention Management:** Implemented targeted ELI interventions that reduced early attrition by proactively addressing employee concerns, fostering strong manager-employee connections, and embedding values-driven engagement practices.
- **Onboarding Excellence:** Partnered with Recruitment & L&D to craft end-to-end onboarding journeys, ensuring **role readiness within 30–45 days** and accelerating new hire productivity.

Employee Relations & Policy Governance

- Acted as **SPOC for Employee Relations**, managing workplace investigations, grievances, conflicts, and employee discipline issues in line with company policies and labor laws.
- Handled **end-to-end redressal of employee complaints** ensuring timely, fair, and confidential closure with proper documentation in all relevant systems.
- **Led Workplace Harassment Committee**, driving compliance with POSH and ensuring sensitive handling of cases.
- Conducted **fair and thorough investigations** into allegations of harassment, discrimination, bullying, policy breaches, and workplace misconduct.
- Partnered with **Legal, Compliance, HRBPs, and COEs** to ensure unbiased investigations, alignment with labor laws, and risk mitigation.
- Monitored and analyzed **employee relations trends**, recommending and implementing mitigation strategies to enhance workplace culture.
- Drafted, designed, and maintained **HR policies, processes, and regulatory frameworks** aligned to organizational goals.
- Performed **regular audits of HR processes and policies** to ensure compliance with evolving labor laws and regulations.
- Applied expertise in **employment law and conflict resolution** to ensure fair, consistent, and risk-mitigated outcomes.
- Built **collaborative relationships across ER, Legal, and HR teams**, supporting knowledge-sharing and consistent case handling.
- **Policy Implementation & Governance:** Aligned ELI initiatives with organizational policies, HR best practices, and compliance frameworks, maintaining **100% adherence** across documentation, behavioral guidelines, and Code of Conduct.
- **Cultural Integration & Employer Branding:** Championed DEIB-driven onboarding rituals, recognition programs, and cultural engagement, resulting in **higher satisfaction scores** in early tenure pulse surveys.
- **Employee Advocacy & Well-being:** Established employee listening mechanisms (check-ins, focus groups, stay interviews) that surfaced pain points early, directly improving new hire confidence, trust, and organizational belonging.
- **Cross-functional Leadership:** Acted as a strategic bridge between Operations, HRBPs, Recruitment, and L&D to unify ELI processes, improving consistency across multiple geographies and business units.
- **Technology & Analytics:** Leveraged HRMS and Microsoft Office Suite to track ELI metrics, analyze attrition trends, and generate actionable dashboards for leadership review.
- **Manager Enablement:** Trained line managers on early intervention practices, feedback frameworks, and coaching models to strengthen **first 90-day leadership support**, directly impacting retention and morale.
- **CSR & DEIB Integration:** Wove CSR initiatives and DEIB values into onboarding and engagement activities, ensuring employees connected with organizational purpose from Day 1.
- **Innovation & Best Practices:** Introduced hybrid onboarding models, peer learning frameworks, and sabbatical-ready employee touchpoints, aligning with evolving workforce needs.

Key Achievements:

- Reduced early attrition rate to **single digits (≤10%)**, exceeding industry benchmarks.
- Improved new hire engagement scores by **20% within the first 90 days**.

- Enhanced time-to-productivity by **25% through structured onboarding**.
- Strengthened employer branding, positioning the organization as a **people-first, inclusive workplace**.
- Acted as a **strategic advisor to internal stakeholders**, cultivating collaborative relationships across business units to enhance talent outcomes, engagement, and service quality.
- Led **end-to-end employee experience strategy**, including onboarding, engagement, recognition, and exit processes, to create a consistent and positive workplace journey.
- Addressed **employee grievances**, conducted investigations, and provided resolution support in alignment with HR policy and labour law.
- Leveraged **employee feedback**, **pulse surveys**, and analytics to design high-impact initiatives that improved satisfaction scores and reduced attrition.
- Launched **data-driven R&R initiatives** using digital platforms and pulse feedback to ensure timely recognition, improve engagement scores, and highlight high performers.
- Spearheaded **CSR and DEI initiatives** to embed purpose, equity, and belonging into the organisational culture, resulting in increased employee alignment and social impact participation.
- **Mapped engagement needs** through surveys and focus groups, aligned initiatives with organisational priorities, **allocated and tracked engagement budget to ensure effective year-round program execution**.
- Led **calendarized engagement programs** and interactive events that reinforced company values and strengthened employee-employer connection, such as **cultural festivals, health and wellness programs, and social impact initiatives**.
- Implemented **robust 360-degree performance review cycles** and guided managers through goal setting, calibration, and performance-based rewards.
- Contributed to a **notable rise in employee NPS scores and retention rates**, with measurable improvements in engagement survey results.
- Managed highly confidential employee data, ensuring **regulatory compliance** with Indian labour laws and SOC2 audit standards.
- Led **employer branding initiatives** and campaigns across social media and educational institutions to increase visibility of the brand amongst potential employees.
- Oversaw **vendor management and administrative processes**, aligning vendor performance with organisational standards and compliance requirements, while identifying opportunities for cost savings and operational improvement.
- **Talent Management**
    - Designed and executed talent management training roadmaps and programs across levels, enhancing functional, behavioural, and leadership competencies aligned with organisational capability goals.
    - Orchestrated leadership training and succession interventions, increasing future-ready talent pipelines and strengthening organisational bench strength.
- **Change Management** (Wishlist and Thrivepass M&A)
    - Spearheaded Merger policies, facilitated communication, managed employee transfers, introduced remote work policies and implementation and addressed cultural integration issues.
    - Partnered with senior leadership to develop compensation benchmarks, revise policies, and lead continuous HR process improvement initiatives.
    - Developed training programs, communicated the system's benefits, and addressed employee concerns about its usage.
    - Strategised HR digital transformation journey, enhancing process efficiency through data analytics, dashboard tracking, and workflow automation; Introduced Automation in HR through the introduction of Zoho.
- Designed and implemented **inclusive Hybrid/WFH and DEI policies**—defining flexible work structures

(launched sabbatical leave program), performance metrics, and ongoing inclusion training.
- Regularly collaborated with executive leadership and global stakeholders on **business forecasting**, **workforce planning**, and long-term talent strategies aligned with company growth.

Colt, HR Project Lead (Fixed Term Contract)
May 2023 - Nov 2023

- **Partnered with business leaders** to translate **organisational goals** into targeted HR strategies, driving talent effectiveness, cultural alignment, and business performance.

- **Employee Lifecycle & Early Engagement (0–90 Days):** Designed and executed a structured early employee experience strategy covering onboarding, induction, buddy systems, and cultural assimilation; created a seamless transition from recruitment to role readiness.
- Strategic advisor and **operations specialist** supporting the India HR team with **lifecycle management, compliance, and policy execution**.
- Orchestrated **onboarding programs** with a focus on early career hires, improving time-to-productivity and integration.
- Defined and rolled out HR policies that shaped workplace culture, drove consistency in people practices, and mitigated compliance risks.
- **Supported governance** through consistent HR documentation, audit readiness, and policy updates per India labour regulations and Colt's global HR standards.
- Led **vendor partnerships** to optimise employee insurance and well-being programs, driving higher engagement and benefit uptake.
- Led employee engagement measurement through **eNPS and surveys**, translating insights into actionable plans to address key focus areas.
- Designed and executed **engagement programs** with structured budgeting and calendarised rollouts, driving sustained employee participation and morale.
- Enabled **360-degree performance processes** by partnering with leaders to drive meaningful goal-setting, fair evaluation calibrations, and data-informed reward decisions aligned with business priorities.
- **DEIB Advisor:** Piloted and launched the DEIB roadmap for India, including employee resource groups such as
    - Pride Matters: Supported the ERG group dedicated to LGBTQ employees.
    - YO United (age diversity): Facilitated the forum for different age groups, promoting workplace diversity and brainstorming multiple initiatives.
    - DAN: Worked on projects based on Disability Accessibility Networks.
    - MHFA (Mental Health First Aider): Initiated programs for visible and invisible disabilities.
    - Led communication and implementation of workplace inclusion campaigns and sensitisation workshops.
- **CSR Colt Cares**: Responsible for various CSR initiatives focusing on community development, education, health care, women, and sustainability.
- Drove **ESG programs** on sustainability via carbon footprint reduction and advancing inclusion through gender-neutral infrastructure and accessibility audits.
- Responsible for change management and policy harmonisation during internal HR transformation.

Ferns N Petals, HR Lead/HRBP, Engagement & Branding

India & Gulf, Oct 2020 – Apr 2023

- Strategic HRBP to key business units, collaborating with leaders to design HR practices with business goals.
- Directed reference checks, background verifications, and onboarding initiatives to drive compliance and enhance the new hire experience.
- Acted as **SPOC for employee relations**, managing grievances, conflicts, and disciplinary cases with timely and fair resolution.
- **Led workplace investigations** (harassment, discrimination, misconduct, policy breaches) ensuring confidentiality, compliance, and risk mitigation.
- Facilitated **360-degree employee experience** initiatives across the lifecycle—from induction to offboarding—enhancing engagement, recognition culture, and overall workplace satisfaction.
- Introduced the **Buddy Program for new hires**, enhancing the onboarding experience and reducing early attrition.
- Designed and delivered **R&R frameworks** tailored to blue- and white-collar staff, ensuring motivation and recognition at all levels.
- Planned **leadership capability building and succession readiness** by curating targeted learning journeys, assessment centres, and development programs for critical roles across the organisation.
- Led **end-to-end statutory compliance and vendor governance**, driving regulatory accuracy, SLA adherence, and cost-effective workforce solutions.
- Crafted and **operationalised HR policies**, driving adoption through effective communication, training, and change management.
- Enabled **consistent and value-driven communication** across stakeholder groups, contributing to relationship-building and amplifying the organisation's voice through carefully aligned **outreach and branding efforts**.
- **DEIB Facilitator**
    - Spearheaded attracting, retaining, and developing a diverse workforce through various initiatives: Reformed CRECHE policies.
    - Conducted gender sensitisation and training sessions.
    - Led project on "Pink Leaves" (special leave policies for women).
    - Facilitated focus group discussions, implemented the Felix First policy, and identified high-potential employees.
    - Partnered with the leadership team and marketing to implement inclusive HR campaigns, including second career fairs and gender sensitisation.
    - Led projects and campaigns in collaboration with corporate communications and marketing teams.
- **Employee Engagement**
    - Directed all engagement activities (Wellness, sports & festival) across geographies (India, UAE, Saudi Arabia & Qatar) for 1000+ employees, with budgetary control of INR 60 lacs, ensuring a consistent and localised employee experience.
    - Developed and implemented a comprehensive annual engagement and wellness calendar, promoting work-life balance and team cohesion.
    - Launched and managed the internal brand community platform "FNPTribe" and published monthly newsletters to increase internal communications and morale.

    - Responsible for grievance resolution, conducted employee satisfaction surveys, and used feedback to develop targeted interventions.
- Administered HR policies, led POSH Trainings, and managed external compliance audits.

OYO, CLT Analyst
India, Nov 2019 – Aug 2020

- Delivered high-quality client services to OYO clients across India, enhancing satisfaction and issue resolution.
- Conducted inside sales and client engagement activities to support partner relationships.
- Facilitated training and development sessions for new hires and regional employees.
- Handled administrative tasks and supported process documentation for operational workflows.

Capgemini, Process Lead (Employee Engagement, CSR, Branding)
India, Feb 2016 – Nov 2019

- **DEIB Facilitator**
    - Developed and implemented a transgender inclusion policy.
    - Implemented and fostered gender-neutral environments such as washrooms.
    - Established and managed Capgemini's diversity and CSR strategies, including DEIB campaigns, open mic forums, environmental sustainability projects, and gender inclusion efforts.
- **Employee Engagement**
    - Designed, planned, and hosted high-impact employee and client engagement activities such as town halls, award functions, and corporate celebrations.
    - Created sports and wellness programs to promote employee health and well-being.
    - Conducted open mic sessions to encourage transparent communication between employees and leadership to drive higher engagement among employees.
- Oversaw the reward and recognition programs to motivate and appreciate employees.
- Led employer branding initiatives, including the #LoveYourCareer storytelling campaign and brand ambassador programs.
- Spearheaded talent development initiatives and succession planning in coordination with L&D.
- Inducted newly-hired trainee and conducted communication & product training.
- Played a key role in policy standardisation, internal communications, and reward & recognition program redesign.
- Played multiple cross-functional roles in employee engagement, operations, recruitment, CSR, and internal communications.
- Supported HR in executing campus hiring and employee referral drives, sourcing and screening candidates, and coordinating onboarding and induction.
- Recognised for driving measurable improvements in employee engagement and innovation across business units.

EDUCATION

Subharti University — MBA in HR & Operations (Dual Specialisation)
Mewar University — Bachelor in Arts